

Dauids Temple M.B. Church Bible Study Series

From Welcome to Worship

Creating a Church Where Guests
Can Encounter God

 **DAVID'S
TEMPLE**
MISSIONARY BAPTIST CHURCH



Introduction To Hospitality

When we think of hospitality, we often think of ushers, greeters, and parking lot attendants. However, the Bible teaches that hospitality is not a ministry responsibility for a few; it is an expectation for all believers.

Hospitality is a Christian practice rooted in the Old Testament and perfectly exemplified in Jesus Christ. The expectation to be kind to sojourners and strangers was not just socially acceptable. It was, and still is, a reflection of God's love for humanity.

This study calls us to consider how we relate to guests because it says much about how we relate to God. To be sincere in our Worship to God, we must be hospitable toward strangers.. We will move from knowing God to showing kindness to guests.

During the study, ministry leaders will have an opportunity to lead a bible study with their ministry using **Lesson 6** on **October 21st**.

We will conclude the study with a church-wide conference on **October 28, 2026**, using **Lesson 6**, where we will gather to review the plans created by each ministry and agree on a hospitality policy as a congregation.

What We Will Learn & Do

Understand the biblical expectation for Christian hospitality

Assess our hospitality toward strangers collectively and individually

Identify the impact of hospitality on our worship

List ways that you can practice personal hospitality

Create a plan to increase the hospitality at David's Temple

How To Use This Study

- Take time to read through the listed passages for each lesson during your devotion
- Use the **Studying the Text** section to help you understand what is being said
- Review the **Discussion** section to prepare you for the class discussion
- Meditate on the **Reflection** questions to help you to live out the lesson

Prayer

Lord, teach me to be as kind to strangers as you have been to me. Increase my concern for guests and those who are outside of my circle.

Amen

Lesson 1

Topic: Loving Strangers

Text: 1 Peter 4:9; Romans 12:9-13; Hebrews 13:1-2; Luke 14:12-14

Date: September 9, 2026

Overview

- The term hospitality comes from the Greek word *philoxenos*, which means loving strangers
- Hospitality in the Bible was focused on strangers
- Hospitality in our world focuses on our circles
- Hospitality is the practice of reflecting God's loving-kindness

Studying The Text

1. Who does the writer in the book of Hebrews say we could be entertaining when we entertain strangers?
2. What attitude should we avoid while showing hospitality according to 1 Peter?
3. In Luke 14 who should we invite to our feasts and celebrations according to the parable that Jesus told?
4. What are the marks of a true Christian according to Romans 12:9-13?

Discussion

Establishing a biblical definition is an important first step toward growing in hospitality. The practice is rooted in developing a high view of all humanity, especially outside of our circles, so that we might practice kindness towards them.

We cannot have a high view of God and a low view of people. Without the proper view of humanity, we will be tempted to practice hostility instead of hospitality.

Hospitality is a sacrificial practice that requires us to put the needs of others before ourselves, even when it costs.

Prayer

Lord, help me to view humanity through the lens of the Bible. Help me to understand others as beings created in your image. Give me the humility to relate to those who I don't understand. Help me to empathize with those who I don't agree with. Teach me how to be kind to all.

Amen

Lesson 1 Hospitality Assessment

Churches are often not as friendly as they think

- Thom Rainer

Score what is normally true on a scale of 1 to 4. Base scores on what you typically witness on Sunday mornings, rather than intentions. Add the three ratings in each assessment.

Scale: 1 Rarely • 2 Sometimes • 3 Usually • 4 Consistently

Assessment 1: Our Church

Think about what a guest or stranger would normally experience at David's Temple during the last 90 days.

1. Our church notices, greets, helps, and includes guests—not only through assigned greeters.

Hebrews 13:1–2

☐ 1 Rarely ☐ 2 Sometimes ☐ 3 Usually ☐ 4 Consistently

2. Our church makes room for people outside our usual circles, including those who cannot repay or benefit us. *Luke 14:12–14*

☐ 1 Rarely ☐ 2 Sometimes ☐ 3 Usually ☐ 4 Consistently

3. Our church gives time, attention, and practical help without complaining, even when hospitality is inconvenient. *Romans 12:9–13; 1 Peter 4:9*

☐ 1 Rarely ☐ 2 Sometimes ☐ 3 Usually ☐ 4 Consistently

Church total: _____ / 12

3–5	6–8	9–10	11–12
Needs attention	Inconsistent	Getting there	Hospitable Church

Assessment 2 My Practice

Think about your normal treatment of guests and strangers during the last 30 days.

1. I notice and approach guests and strangers with dignity, warmth, and genuine interest.

Hebrews 13:1–2

☐ 1 Rarely ☐ 2 Sometimes ☐ 3 Usually ☐ 4 Consistently

2. I make room in conversations, meals, and relationships for people outside my circle, including those who cannot repay me. *Luke 14:12–14*

☐ 1 Rarely ☐ 2 Sometimes ☐ 3 Usually ☐ 4 Consistently

3. I give time, attention, or practical help without grumbling, even when hospitality costs me comfort or convenience. *Romans 12:9–13; 1 Peter 4:9*

☐ 1 Rarely ☐ 2 Sometimes ☐ 3 Usually ☐ 4 Consistently

Personal total: _____ / 12

3–5	6–8	9–10	11–12
Needs attention	Inconsistent	Growing habit	Consistent practice

Taking Action

Do you feel that your score for the church is accurate? Why or why not?

Do you feel that your personal score is accurate? Why or why not?

Within the next seven days, what will I do to make room for someone outside my circle?

Lesson 2

Topic: Entering Worship

Text: Psalm 100:1-5, I Kings 3:7

Date: September 16, 2026

Overview

As Christians we must remember that the Lord our God is a Holy God. How we prepare to serve Him matters. Preparation must be made if we are to worship and reverence Him. We were made for the very purpose of giving honor and glory to Him.

How we come to the church matters! Before entering for worship, it's important to prepare your heart and mind for God's presence. This includes laying aside personal sin and impurity, seeking reconciliation with others, and repenting of wrongdoing. Our approach should be made with clean hands and a pure heart. To do so we must purify our heart, reconcile with others, and approach Him with humility.

Studying The Text

1. How did the Psalmist say we are to come before God?
2. What animal did the Psalmist call God's people?
3. How are we directed to enter God's gates?
4. What problem did David request help with?
5. Who did David request help from and why?

Discussion

In this lesson the psalmist explains to us how we are to come before God. The psalmist states our low position and highlights the high position of God. The psalmist reminds us of the blessings God has already given us and the joy that comes with serving Him.

Prayer

Lord, I thank you for allowing us to come before your presence. Father, we need you every day. Teach us how to go out and come in. Thank you, Lord.

Amen

Lesson 2 Reflection

1. What is your normal Sunday morning routine?
2. How do you prepare to enter worship
3. What do you take into worship?
4. What can you do to improve the way you enter for worship?
5. As a result of this lesson, what changes do you plan to make to your Sunday morning routine?

Notes:

Lesson 3

Topic: During Worship

Text: James 1:21-22, 1 Peter 2:1-3

Date: September 23, 2026

Overview

The goal during worship is to open your heart to receive the Word of God. We are to become eager and ready to receive His Word with meekness. This means actively engaging with other believer in the worship, music and listening attentively to the sermon.

This will allow the message to transform our thoughts and actions.

Singing, praying, and reflecting together create a space where God's truth is applied to your life. In so doing we create an atmosphere that is welcoming, not pressuring, so the worshippers can focus on God rather than impressing others.

Studying The Text

1. What did James say we need to get rid of?
2. What did James say we need to receive?
3. What did James say we need to become?
4. What did Peter say we should have a desire for?
5. What is to be gained from just a taste?

Discussion

Have you ever attended a worship service expecting to receive something and left feeling nothing?

Have you ever wondered why your praise and worship seems to stop short of the finish line?

Prayer

Lord, help me to see you. Please remove any barriers that hinder me from true service to you. Thank you, Lord, for loving me. Amen

Lesson 3 Reflection

1. What is the best part of the worship service to you?
2. What distracts or hinders you during worship?
3. Are you ever a distraction or hindrance to others during worship?
4. What actions can you take to improve the worship service?
5. Do you believe your life can be changed during worship? Explain.

Notes:

Lesson 4

Topic: After Worship

Text: Romans 12:1-2, Ephesians 4:1-6

Date: October 7, 2026

Overview

As Christians and believers of the Word we are to apply the Word to our lives.

After experiencing the service, we must now live what we have heard. We must now move from reception to execution. This could mean serving in the church, making personal lifestyle changes, or deepening your relationship with God through prayer, fasting and bible study.

We must use the fresh spiritual energy from worship to make God's truth real in your daily life.

Studying The Text

1. How did Paul say we should present ourselves to God?
2. How are we supposed to be transformed
3. How did Paul say we are to walk in our Vocation?
4. What does Ephesians 4:3 mean to you?
5. Does Ephesians 4:4 say we all have a calling? Explain.

Discussion

Can you feel the presence of God in your life?

Do you have a hunger to be closer to God?

Do you have a thirst to move from where you are to where God wants you to be?

Do you find yourself asking God, "Lord what do you want me to do?"

Prayer

Lord God, Here I am. I am ready to be used by you. I am offering myself to you. Please use me as you see fit. Thank you, Lord. Amen

Lesson 4 Reflection

1. Do you create time to speak with guests and welcome conversation?
2. Do you find comfort in your holy huddle?
3. After the worship service is over how do you reflect on it?
4. Name one way for you to apply the message to your life?
5. As a result of the worship experience, how are you better able to serve?

Notes:

Lesson 5

Topic: Follow Up

Text: Ephesians 1:15-17, 2 Corinthians 9:12-13

Date: October 14, 2026

Overview

One way to witness growth in our faith is in our ability to pray. Mature Christians should recognize prayer as their most powerful gift from God.

Prayer should be fervent and deliberate. Prayer should be made individually and corporately. It should be offered on behalf of the church, for the individual, the congregation, the community, the sick and the lost.

Prayer is needed prior to the worship service, during the worship service and after the worship.

Studying The Text

1. What did Paul say he heard about the Ephesians?
2. What did Paul do after hearing this?
3. How does our abundance of giving help others?
4. Who did Paul say this type of service helps?
5. How does the test of love in 2 Corinthians 9:13 glorify God?

Discussion

In this lesson Paul joins his prayers with the prayers of the saints in Ephesus. What would be the outcome if we joined our prayer together?

What could we achieve if we came on one accord in the name of Jesus?

What goal(s) are you ready to fervently pray to achieve?

Prayer

Lord, I am here ready to stand my watch in the watch tower of your divine grace. I pray for the circumstances around me that I have no control. Help me Lord, as I pray fervently for situations that only you can fix. Keep me prayerful and watchful as you see fit. Thank you, Lord. Amen

Lesson 5 Reflection

1. How much time each day do you spend in prayer?
2. When and where do you normally pray?
3. Do others call on you to pray with/for them? Why?
4. Who or what do you normally pray for?
5. What can you do to improve your prayer life?

Notes:

Lesson 6

Topic: Making Our Church Hospitality Plan

Text: Romans 12:9–13; Hebrews 13:1–2; Psalm 100:1–5; James 1:22; Ephesians 4:1–3; Ephesians 1:15–17

Date: October 21 & 28, 2026

Overview

Hospitality is the work of the whole church. In this lesson, we will use what we learned in Lessons 1–5. We will think about a guest's visit from start to finish.

Ministry Leaders will meet with their ministries on **October 21st** to teach the lesson and create a plan to present on **October 28th**.

Then we will make a simple hospitality plan for David's Temple. The plan will tell us what to do, who will help, and when each step should happen.

Our Goals

- Review the main idea from each lesson
- Look at our church through the eyes of a guest
- Create one clear hospitality plan that we can use on Sundays

What Is a Protocol

A protocol is a clear plan. It tells people what to do in the same situation. Our first plan will be a draft. We can test it and make it better.

One Hour Session Plan

10 minutes	Review Lessons 1–5
15 minutes	Talk about a guest's visit
25 minutes	Make our hospitality plan
10 minutes	Agree on the plan and choose the next step

Step 1: Review What We Learned

Work in a small group. Choose a leader, a writer, a timekeeper, and a speaker. Read each big idea. In the last column, write one way our church can live it out.

Lesson	Big idea	One way our church can live it out
1 Loving Strangers	Make room for people outside our normal circle.	
2 Entering Worship	Prepare our hearts and help others get ready to worship.	
3 During Worship	Remove things that keep people from hearing God's Word.	
4 After Worship	Put God's Word into action through service.	
5 Follow Up	Keep caring through prayer, giving, and contact.	

Key Question

What should every guest know or feel after visiting David's Temple?

Step 2: See the Visit Through a Guest's Eyes

Think about a person who has never visited our church. The person does not know our building, our people, or our usual way of doing things. Talk about each part of the visit.

Part of the visit	What should happen	What can we do better
1 Before the visit		
2 Parking and entrance		
3 Before worship		
4 During and after worship		
5 Follow up		

Key Question

Which part of the visit needs the most attention? Why?

Steps 3 and 4: Make the Plan and Agree

Now make one simple plan. Write one action for each part of the visit. Then name who will help and when the action should happen.

Part of the visit	We will	Who will help
1 Before the visit		
2 Parking and entrance		
3 Before worship		
4 During and after worship		
5 Follow up		

Check Our Plan

Read each line aloud. If someone is unsure, listen to the concern.

- ☐ Yes ☐ Needs work Does the plan agree with what we learned from the Bible?
- ☐ Yes ☐ Needs work Will the plan help guests feel seen and welcome?
- ☐ Yes ☐ Needs work Is each action clear and easy to understand?
- ☐ Yes ☐ Needs work Can our church do each action well?
- ☐ Yes ☐ Needs work Does each action have someone to carry it out?

Closing Prayer

Lord, help us welcome strangers and care for every guest. Help us follow the plan we made together. May our actions show your love. Amen